rough idea of your combined federal, state, and local marginal rate. To calculate your federal, state, and local marginal income tax rate more precisely, consult your state's tax booklet to find out your true state and local marginal rate. You can get a copy by calling your state's department of taxation (or reaching it online via www.taxsites.com). Inside you'll find tables to help you figure out your state and local rates.

Figure 9-1
2009 TAX RATES

Filing Status	For taxable income that is:	Marginal rate is:
Single	Not over $8,350	10%
	Over $8,350 but not over $33,950	15%
	Over $33,950 but not over $82,250	25%
	Over $82,250 but not over $171,550	28%
	Over $171,550 but not over $372,950	33%
	Over $372,950	35%
Married couples filing jointly	Not over $16,700	10%
	Over $16,700 but not over $67,900	15%
	Over $67,900 but not over $137,050	25%
	Over $137,050 but not over $190,200	28%
	Over $190,200 but not over $372,950	33%
	Over $372,950	35%
Married couples filing sepa-rately	Not over $8,350	10%
	Over $8,350 but not over $33,950	15%
	Over $33,950 but not over $68,525	25%
	Over $68,525 but not over $104,425	28%
	Over $104,425 but not over $186,475	33%
	Over $186,475	35%

Figure 9–1 2009 TAX RATES

Remember, your marginal rate does not indicate what percentage of your income will go toward tax. In the example above, if your annual taxable income was $35,000, most of your money would be taxed at a rate of either 10% or 15% rather than at the marginal rate of 25%. Your overall rate, known as your **effective tax rate,** is a blended, or weighted, average of the tax rates that apply to your income. In this case it's a weighted average of 10%, 15%, and 25% that results in an effective tax rate of about 14%.